

MODEL ANSWERS & EVALUATION GUIDE

Subject: Cyber Law and Ethics

Total Marks: 10 Marks

Academic Year: 2026

Confidential: For Evaluation Only

Question 1 (5 Marks)

An e-commerce website was attacked during a festival sale. Later investigation revealed weak password policies and outdated software. Analyze the planning mistakes that allowed the attack to succeed. Explain how vulnerability identification and timing strategy played a role.

1. Planning Mistakes & Security Gaps:

- **Lack of Proactive Maintenance:** Keeping software outdated signifies a failure in patch management configuration. Known exploits are easily leveraged by attackers when updates are neglected.
- **Inadequate Access Controls:** Weak password policies lower the threshold for brute-force or credential-stuffing attacks, compromising administrative or user backends during high-stakes periods.

2. Role of Vulnerability Identification:

- Attackers conduct reconnaissance long before launching an exploit. By identifying unpatched server-side components and standard entry paths vulnerable to automated script attacks, they map out risk-free infiltration vectors.

3. Role of Timing Strategy:

- **High-Traffic Distraction:** Initiating the breach during a high-profile festival sale ensures that the internal IT/Security team is overwhelmed handling massive consumer transactional volume and server load, filtering or delaying critical security alerts.
- **Maximum Financial & Reputational Leverage:** Targeting business spikes compounds operational damage, forcing businesses into vulnerable negotiation or hasty recovery traps.

Question 2 (5 Marks)

A company experienced a DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service) attack during a public product launch event. Analyze why attackers might choose specific timing and attack methods. Compare the impact of poor preparation versus strong cybersecurity planning.

1. Strategy Behind Timing and Attack Methods:

- **Targeting the Launch Window:** Public events demand high infrastructure availability. Attackers choose DDoS attacks because they directly threaten operational uptime, denying legitimate customers access when visibility is at its peak.
- **Resource Exhaustion:** Volumetric or application-layer attacks flood network pipes, ensuring maximum disruptions with minimal advanced access required by threat actors.

2. Comparative Impact Analysis:

Poor Preparation Impact	Strong Cybersecurity Planning Impact
• Extended system downtime and immediate lost revenue during the event. • Severe reputational damage, damaging customer trust and media perception. • Chaotic reactive response due to missing incident frameworks.	• Automated rate limiting and cloud-based traffic scrubbing minimize disruption. • Fast incident response execution through predefined playbooks. • Uptime preservation safeguards public trust and brand equity.